Query from a current Year 13 student wanting to do Optometry at Herts

3 messages

Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com> 31 January 2024 at 19:21
To: askoptometry@herts.ac.uk

Hello

I hope you are well.

I am a student currently in Year 13 due to sit A Levels in Biology, Chemistry and Physics this year.

I am currently, based on my performance at A Level, predicted two C's in Chemistry and Biology (a borderline C in Chemistry, close to an D) and a B in Physics. I have applied to do Medicine and also Dentistry but have been rejected from all of the medical schools I applied for.

I have read the entry requirements on the course site for the Masters in Optometry and have given consideration to applying, but I think, personally that the entry requirements are too high. I believe you should lower them to B and C grades so students like myself can enter the course.

Are the entry requirements at least in part based on the academic difficulty of the course?

I have contacted admission tutors at Aston University (I applied to do Medicine there as one of my offers- was rejected) who have advised me on this; that indeed the depth and difficulty of the academic content of the course is a factor when entry requirements are set.

They then advised me that based on my grades Medicine may not be suitable for me, due to its academic rigour and difficulty.

Would I be more suited to choosing a different course with lower requirements? If so, why?

I have read online that course entry requirements really are quite superfluous and unnecessary and actually are barring many students from entering a course as that course's academic difficulty is not on par with their grades (I.e they are not suitable and should choose a different course) and this infuriates me. I personally feel that the entry requirements of AAB to AAA are far, far too high.

I would really like to do Optometry but understand that I may not be able to meet the requirements. However, I was on EEU in my A Level subjects in Year 12. Now I am on BCC. Why shouldn't I be allowed admission? I have shown improvement...

I have been thinking about doing a Diploma in perhaps Dog Grooming, as you don't even need GCSE passes for that.

Ultimately as you involved in the Masters in Optometry course at Hertfordshire you should have a say in lowering the requirements to BCC or BBB for this course so students like myself can enter.

Many thanks

Tom Piccolo

Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com> 5 February 2024 at 14:54
To: askoptometry@herts.ac.uk

Hello

I am kindly requesting a response to my email in due course

Many thanks

Tom Piccolo
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askoptometry, UH <askoptometry@herts.ac.uk> 13 February 2024 at 16:48
To: Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>

Dear Tom,

Many thanks for getting in touch.

For applicants wishing to join the Master of Optometry course offered by the University of Hertfordshire (in September 2024), we require:

MASTER OF OPTOMETRY COURSE

Grades AAB at A-level with **at least two A-levels from science subjects** (i.e. Biology, Human Biology, Maths, Physics or Chemistry). **One of the science A-Levels must be from Biology or Maths**. The **practical elements of the science subjects must also be passed**. For **students re-sitting their A-levels, we require Grades AAA**.

or **Grade DDD: BTEC Extended Diploma with a science profile** (not including Early Years or Health and Social care). Must be science-based subject to include Maths, Physics, Chemistry, Biology/Human Biology or Applied Science **plus one A-level in Maths or Biology at grade B or above.**

or **Access to HE Diploma in Science, Medicine or Allied Health** to include 60 credits overall (must include Biology, Chemistry, Maths and Physics) with 45 at Level 3, 30 of which must be at Distinction (to include Biology or Maths) and the remaining 15 at Merit. 15 credits must be in Biology and 15 credits in Maths.

In addition to the above, we also require **at least 5 GCSEs at Grade 5/B or above (including 5/B in English Language, Maths and the Sciences).**

All higher qualifications considered as part of the application process must be within **five years** of the course commencement date.

https://www.herts.ac.uk/courses/undergraduate/moptom-master-of-optometry

In light of the questions you've asked;

The entry criteria listed above is based on the academic difficulty of the course as well as the requirements of the General Optical Council - the regulatory body for Optometry in the UK.

Whether or not the Admissions Tutor at Aston University was right, that the "academic rigour and difficulty" of Medicine may not be suitable for you - we cannot say. It is also entirely up to you whether you choose a "different course with lower requirements"

We're not sure what website(s) you've visited but you're entitled to your opinions on the importance of course entry requirements. You are however somewhat right, the entry requirements are in place to bar candidates who may not be suitable for the course - that is precisely the reason why every university course has them.

As mentioned above, we require all applicants to have achieved the requirements listed above for an offer to be made to join our course. Therefore, as things currently stand, we would not be able to offer you a place on our course.

Hopefully this helps clarify the situation with regards to our requirements. We'd like to wish all you all the best in whatever path you choose to pursue.

Kind regards,
Optometry Admissions Team
University of Hertfordshire

From: Tom Piccolo <tompiccolo50@gmail.com>
Sent: 05 February 2024 14:54
To: askoptometry, UH <askoptometry@herts.ac.uk>
Subject: Re: Query from a current Year 13 student wanting to do Optometry at Herts

You don't often get email from tompiccolo50@gmail.com. Learn why this is important

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